

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 166

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor the East Nashville High School girls' track and field team on winning the 2024 Class A state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those successful athletic teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable group of young women is the East Nashville High School girls' track and field team that won the 2024 TSSAA Class A state championship; and

WHEREAS, the 2024 crown marks the fifth state championship that the Lady Eagles have captured in the past ten years, having previously brought home the gold in the four consecutive years of 2016, 2017, 2018, and 2019; and

WHEREAS, the following young women are proud to be East Nashville Lady Eagles: Kalia Baker, Aziaah Shute, Amiaya Shute, JaMya Horton, Johnne' Newsom, Jazell Freeman, and Averyuna Beckley, and alternates, Brooke Wilson, Alexa Martinez, and Cara Dennis; and

WHEREAS, East Nashville was fortunate to have the leadership and expertise of head coach, Wayne Hines; assistant coaches Kanellar Carney, Victoria Cunningham, and Erica McSwain; and honorary coach and athletic principal, Dr. Marvin Olige; and

WHEREAS, executive principal, Myra Taylor; the student body and faculty; and the entire East Nashville community enthusiastically supported the Lady Eagles on their championship quest; and

WHEREAS, excellence in track and field is no rare feat for East Nashville, as the Lady Eagles have won more state championships (five) and earned more runner-up finishes (five) than any other Tennessee public school in the past ten years; and

WHEREAS, the members of the East Nashville High School girls' track and field team distinguished themselves by winning the state championship with the fewest participating athletes in history (seven); and

WHEREAS, the Lady Eagles also became the first team to tie for a state championship, finishing the meet with 78 points; and

WHEREAS, in addition, East Nashville has produced 168 medal-winning athletes, the most in Metro Nashville Public Schools history, and forty-eight athletes who have received full college scholarships, thirty-two of which are academic scholarships, in the past eighteen years; and

WHEREAS, in claiming state laurels, East Nashville exhibited talent that has been recognized far beyond the Capital City; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Eagles epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, their perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent not only made possible a championship season but also surely bode well for each athlete's future success; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the East Nashville High School girls' track and field team, not only for winning the state title but also for the athletes' superior sportsmanship and the joy they brought to their fellow students and fans; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the East Nashville High School Lady Eagles girls' track and field team upon winning the TSSAA Class A state championship. We salute these exceptional young women for their many accomplishments,

both on and off the track and field, and extend to them our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.